



ORGANISMS come in *all shapes* and *sizes* and have a wide variety of different lifestyles. Even so, some of them are just plain weird by anyone's standards. Here are a few of the *bizarre things* that share our planet.



Aye-aye

The aye-aye is such a spooky-looking mammal, it is regarded as a demon in its native Madagascar. This nocturnal primate uses echolocation to find its prey, tapping on trees with its long middle finger and listening for the sound of insects under the bark. Then it uses its extra-long finger to fish them out.

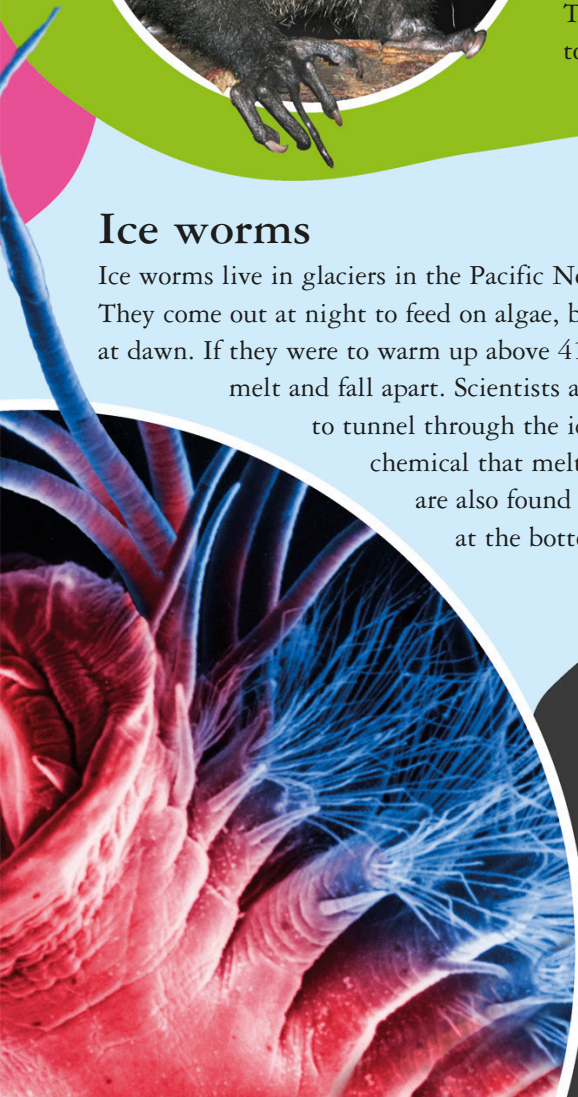


Axolotl

Axolotls are a type of salamander. Unlike other amphibians they never grow up and walk on land. Instead, they keep their feathery gills and spend all their lives in the water. Axolotls have a unique ability to regenerate lost limbs and even parts of their brain, which makes them interesting subjects for medical scientists.

Ice worms

Ice worms live in glaciers in the Pacific Northwest and Canada. They come out at night to feed on algae, but retreat back under the ice at dawn. If they were to warm up above 41°F (5°C) they would literally melt and fall apart. Scientists are unsure how they manage to tunnel through the ice—some think they secrete a chemical that melts the ice in front of them. They are also found in freezing-cold methane deposits at the bottom of the ocean.



Horseshoe crab

These strange-looking creatures are a type of "living fossil"—survivors of animals that lived 300 million years ago. Horseshoe crabs are sea dwellers, but are related to spiders and scorpions. The head and chest are fused together, and they have six pairs of limbs, all covered by a hard outer shell.

